

Does making a typo in ChatGPT consume more water/energy?

Posted by u/GreatNameLOL69 • 0 points • 8 comments

I mean AI models in general; Because it technically tries to understand your typo first, as opposed to just knowing it immediately otherwise..?

Comments

u/Mediocre-Tonight-458 • 1 points • 2026-01-10 16:23 UTC

This Reddit post will result in more consumption of energy/water than all the typos you'd ever make

u/igotshadowbanned • 1 points • 2026-01-10 11:33 UTC

>Because it technically tries to understand your typo first

It doesn't "try" to actually understand anything. It's just very in depth pattern recognition.

ChatGPT doesn't know "Penguins can't fly". It just knows if you have "Penguin" and "Fly" the word "Can't" is frequently between them. That's the basis of ChatGPT but many more layers of abstraction and complexity.

u/Chickenjon • 1 points • 2026-01-09 03:28 UTC

Using chatgpt barely consumes water, it's the training process that's a guzzler.

u/fibsthemman • 1 points • 2026-01-08 23:39 UTC

No. You will use the exact same amount of energy on average and get a less-useful result than usual on average.

Your premise is mistaken. LLM does not "understand" the data it processes, technically or otherwise. It's been conditioned ("trained") to recognize that data A is "more relevant" to data B, but it has no idea *why* that data is relevant. Given data A, it is programmed to return data B more often than chance.

Your typo changes data A, therefore data B is a different part of the data set, and that's the only effect on the LLM. If data B now happens to include calling out your typo, then the AI will do so, but it has no idea it is doing so. It does not know what the content is of data A or B, nor does it care. It returns pseudorandom data that is supposedly relevant to the data A you gave.

u/MrMegaPhoenix • 4 points • 2026-01-08 17:52 UTC

You waste more energy/water on throwing a piece of paper in the trash from a mistake

u/NightRat23 • 1 points • 2026-01-08 17:38 UTC

You know, I bet ChatGPT's just chuckling at our typos, thinking, "You humans and your quirky misspellings!" It's probably like trying to teach a toddler to spell it might be a bit more fun for the AI, but not really any more work.

u/AgentElman • 2 points • 2026-01-08 17:28 UTC

The amount of energy used by a chatgpt response is trivial.

People talking about how much water AI uses are using inflated numbers for all possible planned AI usage in the future and pretending it is what it takes to respond to a chatgpt question.

u/DiogenesKuon • 2 points • 2026-01-08 17:27 UTC

LLMs won't don't try to fix spelling mistakes, for the most part, they just try to work around them. You may get a worse response if the misspelling causes confusion. In any case the electricity cost of a single query is tiny, about as much as running a single lightbulb for 30 seconds, so you should concern yourself with query usage to the same degree you do to turning on a light momentarily to find something in a room.

u/RevaniteAnime • 2 points • 2026-01-08 17:27 UTC

No. The amount of whatever is used to process an input is solely based on how many tokens that input breaks down into. It's not really "fixing" or "understanding" a typo first, and long as the typo is "close enough" the model will statistically "understand" the input that it probably should have been.

u/TESAxo • 1 points • 2026-01-08 17:24 UTC

not really it just sees the typo as another token and guesses the meaning instantly so no extra energy spent